> human, a life, not for this life only, but a transfigured and eternal life – again I should point to India.[23]

The Hindutvatistas' chauvinist, sectarian repackaging of the past now threatens to become mainstream thinking. In many instances it comes from seemingly authoritative sources and therefore demands to be taken seriously – and never more so than when it comes from well-respected religious figures. One such is the very personable Gaudiya Vaishnava guru Swami Bhakti Vijnana Giri, best known as Giriraj Swami, who teaches at the Sri Narasingha Chaitanya Ashram on the banks of the Kaveri in Tamil Nadu as part of ISKCON (the International Society of Krishna Consciousness), better known as the Hare Krishna movement. Born Glenn Phillip Teton in Glencoe, Illinois, Giriraj Swami is the author of *Myth of the Aryan Invasion*, which he concludes by asking 'why this ugly vestige of British imperialism is still taught in Indian schools today? Such serious misconceptions can only be reconciled by accepting that the Aryans were the original inhabitants of the Indus Valley region, and not a horde of marauding foreign nomads. Such an Invasion never occurred.'[24]

This indigenist or 'out of India' theory, which holds that the Arya were descendants of the Harappans and that the Indo-European language group had its origins in India, is the fastest-growing element of Hindutva revisionism. But equally troubling is the belief that foreign ideas have polluted Indian culture, as exemplified by the remarks attributed to the present Culture Minister, who at an RSS meeting in September 2015, spoke of his government's determination to 'cleanse every area of public discourse that has been westernised and where Indian culture and civilisation need to be restored – be it the history we read or our cultural heritage or our institutes that have been polluted over years'.[25]